2 Digital literacy: Using the world wide web

You will learn

- how to find information using a web search
- how to spot unsuitable content and behaviour on the internet and world wide web
- how you can report your concerns if you see content or behaviour that upsets you.

We use information every day. We use it to learn, to do our jobs and to enjoy our free time. The world wide web is a great source of information. In this unit you will learn how to search the world wide web to find the information you need. You will learn how to stay safe when using the world wide web.



Talk about...

- What do you like about the internet?
- What do you dislike about the internet?



Learning outcomes: Find information using a web search; Describe how to spot unsuitable internet content and behaviour; describe several ways you can report your concerns



Class activity

Talk about how you use the internet.

Make a list of when you:

- have used the internet for fun
- have used the internet to help with school work
- have been upset by the internet.

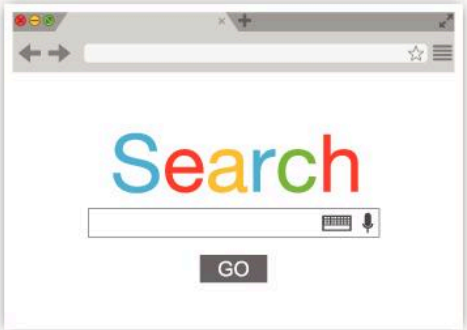
world wide web web page
website web browser
search engine key word
bookmark menu link



Did you know?

There are more than 4 billion people who use the internet worldwide. That is just over half of the world's total population.

At the time of writing, the Google search engine answers 7 billion questions every day. Google has answered around half a million questions while you were reading this!



2.1 About the world wide web

In this lesson

You will learn:

- about the world wide web.

Spiral back

Last year, you learned how to send and receive emails. The internet is used to send emails. In this unit you will learn about another internet service. This service is called the world wide web.

What is the world wide web?

You have probably used the **world wide web**. If you haven't, you will have heard about it. The world wide web is usually shortened to 'www' or 'the web' (we will call it 'the web' in this unit). The web is a great source of information. If you use it in the right way, it will help you to learn at school and at home.

What is a web page?

The information on the web is on **web pages**. A web page contains information about a single topic. A web page might be about your favourite singer or a topic you are studying at school.



A web page can contain text, images, video, sound and animations. These different types of information are called **media**. A web page usually combines several media formats; text and images for example. We say that web pages are **multimedia**.

What is a web link?

Every web page contains **web links**. A web link can be a word or a picture or a button. Clicking a web link takes you to another web page. Web links are what makes the web special. You can follow links to find new information.

What is a website?

Web pages are kept together on a **website**, like pages in a book. A website is owned by a person or organisation. Governments own websites. Newspapers and TV channels own websites. Anyone can own a website.

Browsing the web



When you use the web, you can go to a website you like and look through the web pages on that site. Sometimes you may move from one website to another to find information you are interested in. This is called **browsing**. We will discuss it in more detail in Lesson 2.4.

What is a web browser?

You use a special application to browse the internet. The application is called a **web browser**. Some popular web browsers are Internet Explorer, Firefox and Google Chrome.

Did you know?

Tim Berners-Lee is a British computer scientist. He invented the world wide web in 1990. He called it 'a lesson for all dreamers … that you can have a dream and it can come true'.





Activity

In a small group, make a questionnaire to find out what your class use the internet for. Here are some ideas: playing games, chatting to friends, sending emails, watching videos, doing school work.



Explore more

If you have time, ask family members to do the survey. What do the results show?



Extra challenge

Create a poster called 'A guide to the world wide web'. Your poster should explain the main terms people need to know about the web (for example 'website', 'web browser'). Try to present the information in an interesting way so that people will remember what the terms mean.

2.2 Searching the web

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to use a search engine to carry out a basic search on the world wide web.

Search engines

Typing a question into a **search engine** is a good way to find information. The search engine looks at your question and provides you with a list of web pages. Some of those web pages will contain the information you need.



Tips for searching the web

1 Use a short clear question

Think about the information you are trying to find. Identify the **key words** and use them in your search. You should be able to find information using three to five words.

A web search question is not like a question you ask in conversation.

- In conversation, you might ask: Who holds the world record in the 100 metres for women?
- In a web search, you only need to use the key words. In this example, the key words are 'world record 100 metres women'.





Activity

Sunny is working on a project about big cats. He is researching the jaguar. He wants to find facts about the jaguar's diet and habitat.

Write down four or five key words that describe Sunny's task. We've included a letter/ letters from some key words to help you.

b___ c___	j_____	f_____	d_____	h_____

Experiment with the key words in an internet search. Can you find the information Sunny needs? How many key words did you use? What is the best combination of key words?

2 Think about the best order for your key words

The most important key words should come first. In this example, the word jaguar should come near the start of your search.

3 Do not use punctuation or short, common words

A search question does not need to be written in full. Leave out punctuation marks like commas, full stops and question marks. You can also leave out short, common words like 'and', 'the' and 'a'.



Activity

Selina loves pizza. She wants to find a recipe for a pizza to cook at home. Her favourite pizza is margherita, but she would like to see recipes for other vegetarian pizzas.

She enters the word 'pizza' into a search engine.

Do the same, to see what results Selina got. Can you help her to write a search question that finds the information she wants?



Think again

Write down a question that you don't know the answer to. For example: How many Olympic medals did Usain Bolt win? or What is the population of China? Then swap your question with a classmate. Who can find the answer first using a search engine?



Extra challenge

In Unit 1, you learned that car factories use robots to make cars. Use a search engine to find a picture of robots at work in a car factory.